



YOU ARE **37 WEEKS AND 5 DAYS**

16 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

The size of your uterus may have reduced slightly as your baby's head becomes more deeply engaged within your pelvis, allowing their body to move down. This can take some of the pressure away from your ribs, which is a welcome relief at this stage.

“When there's going to be a new arrival on the scene, it's important to prepare the little members of your household.”

How you handle introducing the new baby to your children will depend on their age. A toddler might be totally indifferent and unfazed, being more interested in your new baby's toys than the fact that they have a new brother or sister. An older child might be shocked and jealous by the arrival of a new baby, who appears to steal their limelight, and divert their parents' attention.

It's a good idea to prepare your little one several weeks in advance, explaining that the new baby will need a lot of time and attention, will need to be fed and changed regularly, and probably not be much fun for a few months. Focus on how your child can be a great helper, and show them what the new baby will need when they are born. Check some books out from the library that explain how families change when a new baby is born, and ask your child to talk about how they're feeling, and how they think things will be different when the baby arrives.

Encourage your child to choose a gift to give to the baby, and find something your child really wants as a gift from their new sibling. Ask grandparents or close friends to arrange a few treats or outings for your child both now and after the birth so that they're occupied and getting extra attention.

ASK A DOCTOR

My mom had a difficult delivery with me. Am I likely to have the same experience as her? Like many women, you're aware of the details of your own birth.

Some say you'll have the same sort of delivery your mom had with you—for example, your baby will be early or late or you'll have a very quick labor or a slow, assisted one. This isn't necessarily true.

Remember, depending on how old your mom is, there have probably been significant developments in obstetrics since your mom's days and, even if you face the same hurdles during your labor, they might be managed differently.

Also, you might be healthier and stronger than your mom was, so don't assume you're in for a difficult labor just because she had one.